

Beginner Electric Guitar Course

Lesson 1: Meet Your Guitar

Goals

- Learn the basics of your guitar and gear
- Play your first clean notes and a simple melody
- End with your first mini song: *Smoke on the Water* (1-string version)

Part 1: Buying Your First Guitar & Gear

What to Know Before Buying

- **Types of Electric Guitars:**
 - *Stratocaster style*: versatile, bright tone
 - *Les Paul style*: thicker, heavier tone
 - *Superstrat/modern*: designed for rock/metal
- **What matters for beginners**: comfort, weight, neck feel, price (not brand or fancy features)

Essential Gear

- **Amp**: Small practice amp (10–20 watts is enough)
- **Cable**: Standard 1/4" instrument cable
- **Tuner**: Clip-on or app-based tuner (free options exist)
- **Picks**: Medium gauge (0.70–0.88mm) recommended for beginners
- **Optional but useful**: guitar strap, gig bag, headphones

Where to Buy

- **Local Store**: You can try the guitar, get advice, and feel the instrument
- **Online**: More options, good deals, but you can't test before buying

Part 2: Guitar Anatomy

- **Headstock:** tuners/pegs
- **Neck:** frets, fretboard
- **Body:** pickups, bridge, knobs, input jack
- **Strings:** numbered 1 (thinnest, high E) to 6 (thickest, low E)
- **Amp Basics:** gain, volume, EQ (bass, mid, treble)

Part 3: Tuning Your Guitar

- Use a clip-on tuner or app (like Fender Tune, GuitarTuna, etc.)
- Standard tuning (from thinnest to thickest):
E—B—G—D—A—E
- **Tips:** Always tune up to the pitch (if you go sharp, loosen and come back up)

Part 4: Holding Your Guitar & Pick

- Sit with the guitar on your right leg (if right-handed)
- Back straight, shoulders relaxed
- Pick grip: thumb + index finger, leaving about 1/4” of pick exposed
- Rest forearm lightly on the guitar body

Part 5: Your First Sounds

- **Open Strings:** pick each one clearly, letting it ring
- **Fretted Notes:** press close to the fret, not on top
 - Try notes on 1st string:
 - Open string = E
 - 1st fret = F
 - 3rd fret = G

Part 6: Your First Melody

3-Note Melody (E-F-G)

e | ----- |
B | ----- |
G | ----- |
D | ----- |
A | ----- |
E | --0--1--3-- |

- Play slowly and cleanly
- This is your very first melody!

e | ----- |
B | ----- |
G | ----- |
D | ----- |
A | ----- |
E | --0--1--3--1--0-- |

Part 7: Mini Song — *Smoke on the Water* (1-string version)

Part 1

e | ----- |
B | ----- |
G | ----- |
D | ----- |
A | ----- |
E | --0--3--5--0--3--6-5---- |

Part 2

e | ----- |
B | ----- |
G | ----- |
D | ----- |
A | ----- |
E | --0--3--5-----3--0----- |

- Play it slowly, focus on clean notes

Final Exercise of Lesson 1

- Tune your guitar by yourself
- Play open strings clearly
- Play the E–F–G melody (3 notes)
- End by playing *Smoke on the Water* riff on the G string

By the end of Lesson 1, you'll:

- Know how to buy and set up your first guitar
- Understand guitar anatomy and tuning
- Play your first melody and your first famous riff!